

Daily AI, Crypto & Tech Power Briefing

June 29, 2026

AI Hardware Carries Markets; Stablecoins Move Deeper Into Banks

Today is about what actually supports the AI and crypto stories. In AI, investors are still rewarding the hardware layer: memory chips, storage, Nvidia GPUs and the companies selling scarce infrastructure.

In crypto, the strongest positive news is not bitcoin price action. It is institutional stablecoin infrastructure, with BNY preparing to let clients mint, burn, store and transfer USDC directly on its digital-asset platform.

1. BNY gives USDC a deeper route into institutional finance

Wall Street Journal · June 29, 2026

Exclusive: BNY Adds Circle's Stablecoin to Digital-Asset Platform

The story

Bank of New York Mellon, the oldest bank in the U.S., will let institutional clients store, transfer, mint and burn Circle's USDC stablecoin on its digital-asset platform by the end of July.

BNY already safeguards much of the reserve money backing USDC. This new feature makes the bank more than a reserve custodian: it becomes a direct operating layer for institutions that want to move between dollars and tokenized dollars.

Why it matters

This is important because stablecoins are moving from crypto exchanges into large regulated banks. For Circle, BNY support makes USDC look safer and more institutional. For BNY, it opens a path into digital-asset payments and custody without

issuing its own stablecoin.

Regulators will still care about redemption, reserve quality, compliance and money movement. But the direction is clear: the stablecoin market is becoming part of traditional financial infrastructure, not just a crypto trading tool.

What to watch

- Whether BNY expands the platform to other stablecoin issuers after USDC.
 - Whether more institutional clients use USDC for settlement rather than only holding it as a crypto cash balance.
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2. AI chipmakers show where the real money has been made this year

The Guardian · June 29, 2026

Shares in chipmakers underpinning AI boom rocket in first half of 2026

The story

The Guardian reports that AI hardware stocks have produced some of the strongest market gains in the first half of 2026. SK Hynix, Samsung, Micron, Western Digital, Seagate and Sandisk all benefited from demand for memory and storage.

South Korea's market has been one of the biggest winners. The government is also pushing a large investment plan for semiconductors, AI data centers and robotics, with Samsung and SK Hynix expected to build new fabrication plants.

Why it matters

The market is telling a simple story: AI software is exciting, but scarce hardware is where pricing power is strongest right now. Memory and storage companies can benefit even when software companies face questions about margins and return on AI spending.

The policy angle is also important. Chip capacity is becoming national industrial strategy. Countries that control memory, advanced packaging and data-center infrastructure can gain leverage in the AI race.

What to watch

- Whether chip stock gains continue or investors take profits after a huge first half.
- Whether new semiconductor capacity arrives fast enough to reduce memory shortages by 2027 or 2028.

3. Goldman says AI spending can still drive earnings, but the bar is higher

Barron's · June 29, 2026

AI Will Drive Earnings Growth-Again, Goldman Predicts

The story

Goldman Sachs expects AI spending to keep supporting corporate earnings in the second quarter. Barron's reports that Nvidia and Micron could account for a large share of expected profit growth, showing how concentrated the AI earnings story has become.

The important detail is that investors are no longer just asking whether companies are spending on AI. They are asking who is actually earning from that spending and whether enterprise customers are adopting AI fast enough to justify the capex cycle.

Why it matters

For investors, this is the difference between AI hype and AI cash flow. Nvidia, Micron and hardware suppliers benefit first because they sell the inputs. Software companies and enterprise AI users still need to prove that AI improves productivity enough to defend valuations.

For business leaders, the message is practical: AI budgets will be judged by return on investment. Companies that cannot explain how AI lowers costs, raises revenue or improves speed may face pressure to slow spending.

What to watch

- Second-quarter earnings calls from hyperscalers, chipmakers and enterprise software companies.

- Whether companies give concrete examples of AI revenue, cost savings or productivity gains.
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4. Bitcoin slips below \$60,000 because ETF money is still leaving

The Economic Times · June 29, 2026

Bitcoin slips below \$60,000 as ETF outflows and Middle East tensions weigh. Here is what experts say

The story

Bitcoin slipped below \$60,000 on Monday, trading around \$59,915. The pressure came from continued ETF outflows and nervousness around Middle East tensions.

This is the same pattern we have been watching for days: bitcoin has a long-term digital scarcity story, but in the short term it is trading like a risk asset. When ETF investors sell and macro risk rises, bitcoin has trouble holding key levels.

Why it matters

For crypto markets, ETF outflows matter because institutional products helped create the last bull market. When those flows reverse, price support becomes weaker and retail confidence falls.

The losers are miners, exchanges, leveraged traders and crypto treasury companies. Long-term holders may see lower prices as an opportunity, but they need patience because the market still lacks a strong new catalyst.

What to watch

- Whether bitcoin can reclaim \$60,000 and hold it for more than a short bounce.
 - Whether ETF outflows slow in July or continue to pressure the whole crypto sector.
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Useful terms

institutional client - 机构客户	digital-asset platform - 数字资产平台
mint and burn - 铸造和销毁	reserve custodian - 储备托管方
redemption - 赎回 / 兑付	settlement - 结算
pricing power - 定价权	memory chip - 内存芯片
fabrication plant - 晶圆厂	advanced packaging - 先进封装
industrial strategy - 产业战略	capital expenditure - 资本支出
earnings growth - 盈利增长	profit concentration - 利润集中度
return on investment - 投资回报率	enterprise adoption - 企业采用
hyperscaler - 超大规模云服务商	ETF outflows - ETF 资金流出
risk asset - 风险资产	macro risk - 宏观风险
key level - 关键价位	market catalyst - 市场催化剂

Today's big picture

Today's big picture is that the strongest technology themes are becoming more concrete. AI is being priced through hardware profits and earnings power, while stablecoins are gaining credibility through large regulated banks.

Bitcoin is the weak side of the crypto story right now. Stablecoin infrastructure is moving forward, but bitcoin still needs ETF inflows, calmer macro conditions and a new catalyst before confidence returns.